CAST OF CHARACTERS

MUGHAL FOREBEARS

Chenghiz Khan (1162–1227): Also known as Genghis Khan, founder of the Mongol Empire, which became the largest contiguous empire in the world.

Timur (1336–1405): Also known as Tamarlane, Timur-i Lang (Timur the Lame). Founder of the Timurid Empire in and around Central Asia. He was the great-great-great-grandfather of Babur.

THE MUGHALS

Babur (1483–1530): Founder and first Padshah of the Mughal Empire, Akbar's grandfather. A direct descendant of Timur.

Bairam Khan (1501–1561): Persian nobleman from the time of Humayun. Was wakil-e-saltanat and khankhanan during Akbar's reign. Talented general who worked tirelessly to protect the empire when Akbar became Padshah at the age of thirteen. As Akbar began to take more interest in the running of his empire, he began to chafe under Bairam Khan's guardianship and had him dismissed in 1560. He was assassinated en route to Mecca.

Munim Khan (d. 1575): Chaghatai nobleman from the time of Humayun. Ataliq of Akbar. Influential after the defeat of Bairam Khan, and was made khankhanan for a while. Defeated Daud Khan Afghan, and later died in Bengal.

Humayun (1508–1556): Son of Babur, second of the Great Mughals of India, Akbar's father. Had to fight his three brothers, Kamran, Askari, and Hindal, as well as Sher Shah Sur, when he became Padshah of Hindustan. Lost the empire inherited from Babur, the founder of the Mughal Empire, and went into exile to Persia. Eventually reclaimed India but died within six months of returning to power, falling down the stairs of his library.

Bega Begum (1511–1582): Senior wife of Humayun, known as Haji Begum after she completed the hajj. Remained in Delhi after the death of